

MP-110: Spinal Cord Stimulator (SCS) Trial

Bellcourt Medical Policy | Version 2 | Status: ACTIVE | Effective for dates of service 2025-10-01 until superseded

Field	Value
Policy number	MP-110
Service code(s)	BHA-SURG-6350
Applies to	All clients administered by Bellcourt unless the client's plan document or delegation addendum states otherwise
Owner	Clinical Policy Committee
Version	v2

1. Purpose and scope

This policy sets out the clinical criteria Bellcourt reviewers use to decide whether the service described in this policy (Spinal Cord Stimulator (SCS) Trial) is medically necessary. It is applied to prior authorization requests where the date of service falls within the effective period stated above. A client's plan document may exclude this service or impose additional requirements; plan provisions are checked first.

2. Definitions

Medically necessary: services that are appropriate and consistent with the diagnosis, in accordance with generally accepted standards of medical practice, and not primarily for the convenience of the member or provider.

3. Coverage criteria

The service is considered medically necessary when the criteria below are met, read together using the AND / OR connectors shown:

- 1 Chronic neuropathic pain of at least 6 months' duration; AND
- 2 Failure of conservative treatment, including physical therapy; AND
- 3 Documented failure of at least 2 classes of pain medication (e.g. anticonvulsants, SNRIs, tricyclics); AND
- 4 Psychological evaluation clearing the member for implantation.

4. Not medically necessary / limitations

- Pain of under 6 months' duration.
- Fewer than 2 medication classes tried.
- No psychological evaluation.

5. Documentation requirements

Pain history, therapy and medication history, psychological evaluation report.

If required documentation is missing, the request must be pended and the provider contacted for information. It must not be denied for lack of documentation until the information request has gone unanswered within the regulatory timeframe.

6. Version history

Version	Effective	Summary
v1	2024-01-01 to 2025-09-30	Initial version.
v2	2025-10-01	Added requirement for failure of at least 2 medication classes.